

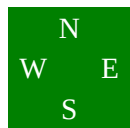
**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8  
♥ J 10 6 3 2  
♦ A 8 5  
♣ 8 4 3 2

♠ Q J 10 7  
♥ K Q 9 8  
♦ 7 6 2  
♣ K Q



♠ A 5 4 2  
♥ 5 4  
♦ K Q 4 3  
♣ 9 6 5

♠ K 9 6 3  
♥ A 7  
♦ J 10 9  
♣ A J 10 7

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              |             | 1 ♣          |
| Pass         | 1 ♥          | Pass        | 1 ♠          |
| Pass         | 4 ♠          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 4 ♠ by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♣ 3    |              |             |              |

When you have two 4-card suits to show you bid them "up-the-line". In this case it means you say 1 ♥. Partner replies 1 ♠.

There are enough points for game and a known 8-card Major fit. So you bid 4 ♠.

Perfect bidding isn't always rewarded. They can win three ♦ tricks and the Ace of trumps. If the opening lead is a ♥ or a ♣ you might make it, so it just depends on luck.

**Board 2**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7 3  
 ♥ A 8 5 3  
 ♦ J 10 5  
 ♣ 4 2

♠ K 10 4

♥ J 9 7

♦ A K 7 2

♣ K 5 3



♠ Q 6 2

♥ Q 4 2

♦ 4 3

♣ Q J 10 8 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K 10 6

♦ Q 9 8 6

♣ A 9 6

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠8

You have two very good choices, neither of which is really wrong. You could bid 2NT, showing 13-16 points, balanced, or you could bid 3♦, showing 13-16 points, good trump support.

What should decide you is the bidding priorities. You'd much rather try to play a 9-trick game than an 11-trick game. And at the same time you must trust your partner not to leave you hung out in Notrump with an unsuitable hand. (Can you believe I wrote Notrump and unsuitable in the same sentence?)

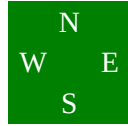
Anyway, you bid 2NT and partner raises to 3NT.

**Board 3**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ Q 6  
♥ A 8  
♦ 10 9 8 5 4  
♣ 10 9 7 4

♠ A K 9 2  
♥ J 5  
♦ K 7 2  
♣ K 8 3 2



♠ J 7 5 4  
♥ 9 7 4 3 2  
♦ J 3  
♣ A 6

♠ 10 8 3  
♥ K Q 10 6  
♦ A Q 6  
♣ Q J 5

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              | 1 ♣          | Pass        | 1 ♥          |
| Pass         | 1 ♠          | Pass        | 3NT          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 3NT by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♦ 9    |              |             |              |

With 14 points and a 4-3-3-3 distribution this could be the perfect hand for a jump to 2NT. But not when the 4-card suit is a Major - you should not skip bidding a Major when you have the opportunity.

So you respond 1 ♥. Partner says 1 ♠.

Partner doesn't have 4 ♥s so you go back to thinking this is an ideal notrump hand. So ideal that you apply the "She who knows, goes" principle and bid 3NT. Partner smiles and passes.

**Board 4**

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 5 4 2  
 ♥ Q 7 5 3  
 ♦ A 5 2  
 ♣ 6 3

♠ A 7

♥ K 9

♦ K J 9 7 4

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ Q J 6

♥ J 6 2

♦ 8 6

♣ K Q 7 4 2

♠ K 10 9 3

♥ A 10 8 4

♦ Q 10 3

♣ A 9

You have great ♦ support and perhaps 15 points. The "perhaps" is because partner may have only 3 ♦s, and if you are the long-trump hand any ruffs you take will probably not increase the number of trump tricks your side makes. But still, you have a great hand.

So you bid 3♦. Partner now says 3NT.

You described your hand very well with your first bid. Partner heard the description and chose 3NT. Since you trust your partner you pass.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1♦    |
| Pass         | 3♦    | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥3     |       |      |       |